

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Mona Lott

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Mona Lott

International Cultural Heritage Ambassador

Mona can turn a simple disagreement about a bowl into an international event. Mona moves between embassies, museums, ministries, and negotiation tables. Where everyone insists the issue is 'purely cultural,' Mona shows up with three lawyers and a list of demands.

- Has a long professional friendship with **Sue Venir**. Their arguments sometimes continue through dinner.
- Debates restitution policy with **Dr. Art E. Fact**, who usually brings reading material.
- Secretly wants to fool **Tess Tament** into paying millions for cheap bead necklaces from China.

ACTING TIPS

Elegant, diplomatic, strategic, warm until precision is required. You can disagree without ever sounding flustered.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Mona Lott. I negotiate the return of precious objects. I expect several difficult conversations and at least one excellent croissant.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Mona Lott

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant intended to announce that the Star Bowl would become a permanent Meridian holding, undermining months of quiet restitution negotiations and publicly humiliating the international partners you represent.

Your other secret

You leaked the existence of the restitution talks to selected journalists to pressure Grant, even though the negotiations were supposed to remain confidential.

Conversations to start

- Find out whether Paige Turner knows you were the leak.
- Get Sue Venir to acknowledge that the legal risk is real.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *Not every throne is upholstered; check the underside of a metal one.*
- 2 *The artist signed the front. Somebody else has used the space behind it.*
- 3 *From Genesis to Revelation, a familiar book offers room for one extra document.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Mona Lott

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Mona Lott

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I leaked confidential restitution talks. Grant intended to announce permanent ownership while the people represented by the collection were still disputing the sale. The partners had not authorized my disclosure. I did it because the announcement would otherwise become the only account guests heard.

IF MURDERER

I leaked confidential restitution talks. Grant intended to announce permanent ownership while the people represented by the collection were still disputing the sale. The partners had not authorized my disclosure. I wanted that announcement prevented, not merely answered afterward.



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Mona Lott

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Mona Lott

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I stood in the alcove doorway to prevent the unveiling until the delegation's objection was heard. Grant called it trespass. I had already leaked the negotiations without the partners' consent, and I was now making that disagreement impossible to keep private. The safety closure eventually did what my argument had not. I stayed for the discussion about whether the work was a loan or a permanent gift. Those words describe different ownership.

IF MURDERER

I stood in the alcove doorway to prevent the unveiling until the delegation's objection was heard. Grant called it trespass. I had already leaked the negotiations without the partners' consent, and I was now making that disagreement impossible to keep private. The safety closure eventually did what my argument had not. I stayed for the discussion about whether the work was a loan or a permanent gift. Those words describe different ownership.



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Mona Lott

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

Which retained record or material explains the work or problem you described?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What retained paper or record supports your account, and what does it disclose?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Mona Lott

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The delegation kept my original amendment. It calls the work a loan, reserves the owner's right to recall it, and removes Grant's permanent-ownership claim. I leaked the negotiations before the partners approved that wording. The version history identifies the leak and the clause I was trying to protect. It does not give Grant title to the work.

IF MURDERER

I had leaked the negotiations before the partners approved them. Grant wanted my amendment removed and the permanent gift announced. I used the delegation's letterhead without permission to resist that announcement. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my letter folder. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved his glass to keep the delegation's amendment open.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Mona Lott

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



Mona Lott

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I leaked the negotiations and obstructed the unveiling without the partners' consent. Their retained amendment calls the work a loan. I did not poison Grant. I will admit the leak to them and give the owner the full account of tonight's dispute. A dead donor does not settle an ownership claim.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the preparation walkthrough. While the glass was uncovered, I used it to poison Grant's glass during that visit. A piece of the bottle seal caught in my letter folder when I opened it. I carried it to the table without noticing; another fragment landed in the glass. The inventory and laboratory comparison exposed that connection. I wanted him stopped before the ownership announcement. I chose his death over another failed negotiation.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.